

GAMING

Now for some help with your fps...



To make your PC play faster, access the graphics card settings by right-clicking on the desktop and going to **Properties > Settings > Advanced**. You can tweak all options from here.

OpenGL settings

For faster fps, and a more enjoyable experience, turn off eye-candy.

Make sure all the options in your graphics card settings are tuned for high performance. Set the minimum levels for—or turn off—resource hungry settings such as Anisotropic Filtering, Anti-Aliasing, Mipmap Detail and Vertical Sync.

Direct3D settings

In your card's Direct3D settings, set all eye-candy to a minimum, or just turn the settings off. Here again, turn off Anti-Aliasing, Anisotropic Filtering, Mipmap Details and Vertical Sync. You may need to enable Fog table emulation for

nVidia cards to avoid seeing a blank screen.

A clean win

Keep your graphics card clean and airy. All that gaming can really test the hardware, and if you're not careful, be prepared to see a BSOD, or worse still, corrupted files after a rather 'hot' reboot.

The area around the graphics card should be open and cables shouldn't obstruct the fan. If possible, install an additional fan on top of your cabinet. With typical motherboard placements, this new fan will blow air straight onto the AGP graphics card.

Get by with a little help

You can get power-user-type control over your graphics card drivers with third-party tools. These will further tweak your card settings for best performance with decent visual effects.

Radeon users can try out PowerStrip (<http://www.entech->

taiwan.net/util/ps.shtm), and nVidia card owners, nVHardPage (www.nvhardpage.com). For those still hanging on to TNT and TNT2 cards, we suggest you use older, stable drivers, instead of the latest Detonator drivers (www.nvidia.com).

The Detonator drivers are optimised for the latest breed of graphic chipsets, and may tax your older cards. Of course, if you can't find the older drivers, stick to the new.

Overclocking

You can overclock your GPU to get better graphics, but there is a limit. Don't expect to get 9800 Pro performance out of your TNT2. There's a very fine line between a faster GPU, and a minor explosion, so be wary. And do bear in mind that overclocking is considered tampering, which voids your warranty. If you have no clue what you're doing, skip these tips.

Using third-party utilities mentioned earlier—

PowerStrip for Radeons and nVHardPage for nVidia's cards—you can tweak your GPU. Go to the clock frequency controller in your respective utility, and increase the clock speed and memory speed at not more than 5 MHz at a time. Keep testing for stability and excessive heat emitted by the card.

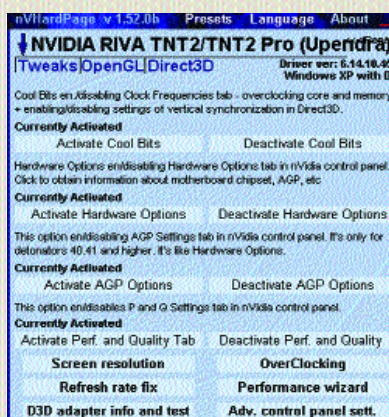
The performance increase begins to go down as you overclock more and more. Use your judgement to get the optimal setting where the overclocking is moderate and the performance gain is satisfactory. As always, add a few fans to your cabinet before you do this.

LAN parties

Before connecting to a game server, close all programs that use the Internet to maximise your connection speed and minimise your ping times. Don't spare even IM applications. Also, exit as many programs and services as you can.

Don't forget the game

Apart from setting the graphics card options, you also need to adjust each game's settings for high performance. This is usually found in the game menu under **Options > Settings > Graphics**, or something similar. Set colour depths, 'details', and all other such settings to Low.



Using tools such as nVHardPage can give you that performance boost you require so badly



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